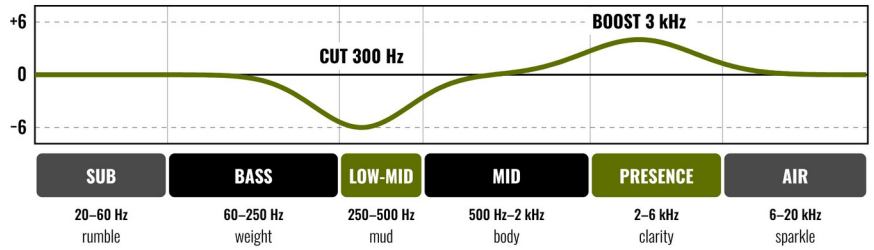
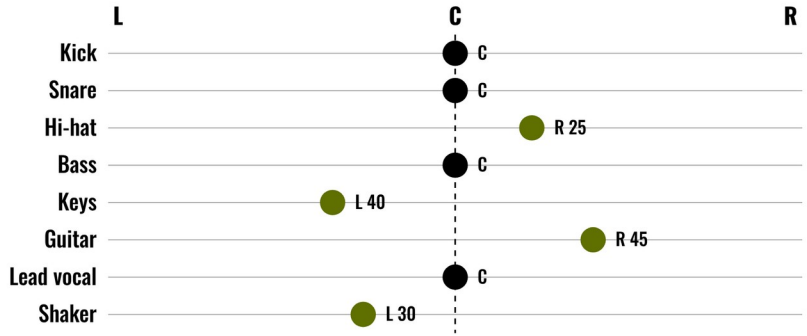
HUDSON BEAT




# FX DEEP DIVE

## Tone. Depth. Space.

DIGITAL MUSIC PRODUCTION 2 · CLASS 1 · EQ, PAN, REVERB AND DELAY IN LOGIC PRO

# LISTEN: DRY, THEN MIXED

## DRY, THEN MIXED

### The same track, played twice

Teacher: play it with every effect bypassed, then with them on.

- What changed between the two?
- Which effect did you notice first?
- Could you hear space, width or clarity?

# WHAT DO EFFECTS DO?

- EQ shapes tone and clarity
- Compression evens out loud and quiet
- Reverb and delay add depth and space
- Panning adds width and separation
- Modulation adds movement

# SEVEN CLASSES

| | |
|---|---|
| CLASS 1 | Dry and mixed · what effects do · choose a source · every effect needs a reason |
| CLASS 2 | EQ demo · pan the band · reverb and delay · compression numbers |
| CLASS 3 | Working day: EQ and pan every track |
| CLASS 4 | Working day: effects with a reason |
| CLASS 5 | Working day: refine the mix |
| CLASS 6 | Refine and bounce · checklist · rubric · 3 questions |
| CLASS 7 | Presentations with Padlet Q&A |

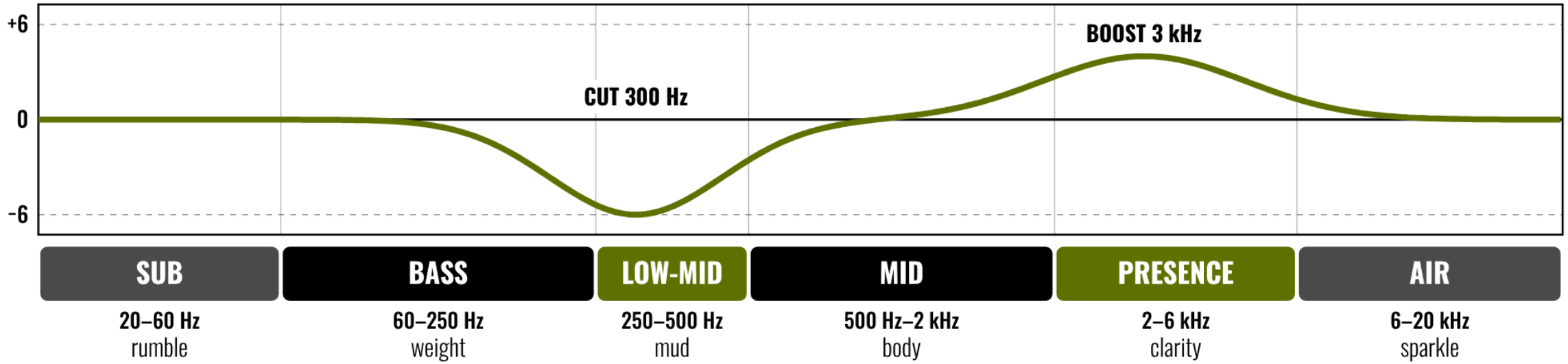
# STEPS 1 AND 2: REVIEW, CHOOSE

1. Review your notes on the 11 FX
2. Choose: your own project or a multitrack
3. A multitrack from Cambridge-MT: 8–16 tracks
4. Not a 40-track session
5. Fill in the Source log

# EVERY EFFECT NEEDS A REASON

- What problem does this effect solve?
- What do I hear when it is on?
- Does it fit the genre?
- Bypass it: is the mix better with it?

# WHERE SOUNDS LIVE

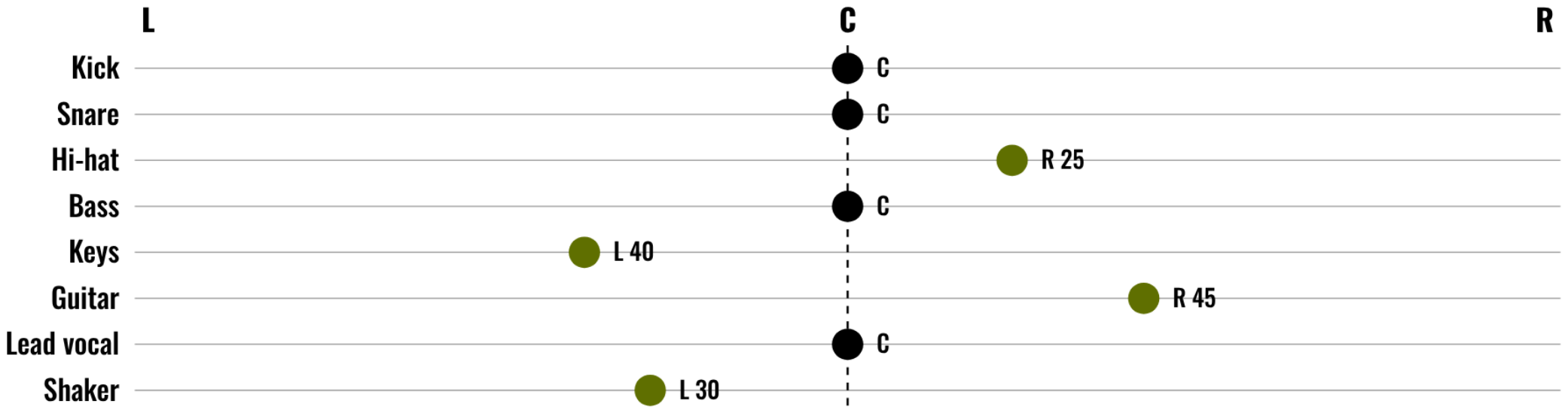



- Cut where tracks crowd each other
- Muddy sounds often live near 300 Hz
- Boost to bring out what you love
- Try a big move first, then back off

# WATCH ME: EQ ON A SOLOED TRACK

1. Solo one track, open Channel EQ
2. Boost a narrow band and sweep it slowly
3. Now cut the same band: hear it vanish
4. Un-solo: is the whole mix clearer?
5. Bypass the EQ and compare (A/B)

# WORKED EXAMPLE: PLACE THE BAND

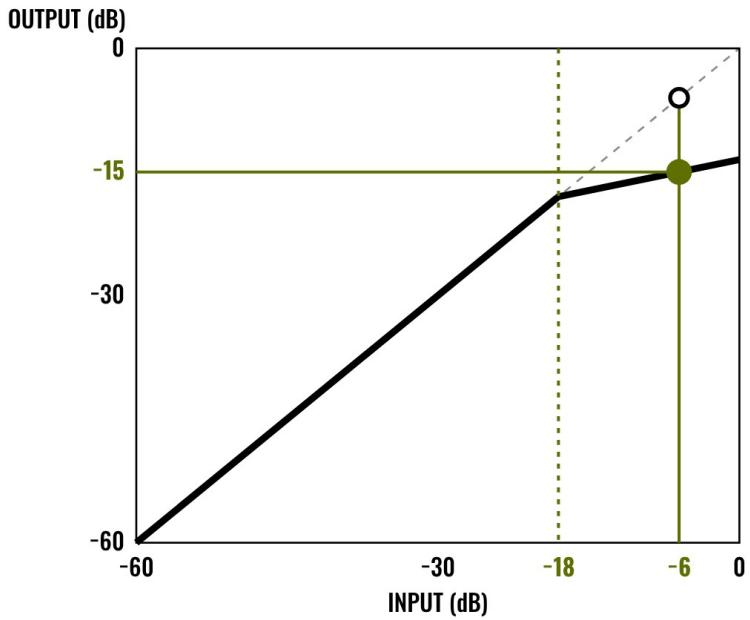



- Kick, snare, bass, vocal: center
- Left and right weigh the same
- Spread the rest, left and right
- Width comes from panning

# WATCH ME: REVERB AND DELAY

1. Click a Send slot, choose Bus 1 (an Aux appears)
2. Add one reverb to the Aux; send to taste
3. Delay time from tempo: 1/8 at 100 BPM = 300 ms
4. Turn it down until you only miss it when off

# WORKED EXAMPLE: COMPRESSION




**Threshold -18 dB**

**Ratio 4 : 1**

A -6 dB peak is 12 dB over

It comes out 3 dB over, at -15 dB

**Gain reduction: 9 dB**

- Quiet sounds pass through unchanged
- A higher ratio squeezes harder
- Only the part over the line is squeezed
- Make-up gain brings the level back

# WORKING DAY: EQ AND PAN EVERY TRACK

- EQ every track, one at a time
- Pan each instrument into its own place
- Fill in the Track map
- Judge it in the whole mix, not only solo

# WORKING DAY: EFFECTS WITH A REASON

- Use at least 5 different FX
- Write the reason in your FX log
- A/B every effect: bypass, listen, decide
- Check on headphones and on speakers

# REFINE, BOUNCE, PREPARE

- Final level and FX tweaks
- Bounce a .mp3 or .wav
- Zip the .logicx project
- Write your 3 Padlet questions

# WHAT YOU TURN IN

- [ ] Bounced .mp3 or .wav of the final mix
- [ ] Zipped .logicx project
- [ ] Named: Your Name – FX Deep Dive
- [ ] At least 5 different FX, ready to discuss
- [ ] All tracks EQ’d and panned
- [ ] Padlet post with your 3 questions
- [ ] Answer 2 questions on classmates’ posts

# HOW IT'S SCORED

| | | |
|---|---|---|
| CREATIVITY & ORIGINALITY | 5 = Exceptional creativity; innovative, bold, and expressive | / 5 |
| TECHNICAL SKILL / DAW USE | 5 = Expert-level command of multiple Logic systems | / 5 |
| COMPOSITION & STRUCTURE | 5 = Professional pacing, flow, and musical arc | / 5 |
| SOUND DESIGN & MIX QUALITY | 5 = Exceptional sound design; professional-quality mix | / 5 |
| DOCUMENTATION & PRESENTATION | 5 = Exceptional; thorough insight and polished delivery | / 5 |

**SCORED 1–5 · FINAL GRADE = AVERAGE OF YOUR SCORE AND MINE · / 25**

# PRESENTATION DAY

- Walk the class through your FX choices
- Your Padlet post: 3 questions about your project
- Answer at least 2 of each classmate’s 3
- Listen like a mixer: what did they do, and why?

# ONE LAST THING...

- You started with a track.
- You shaped tone and space.
- Every effect had a reason.
- Now it sounds like yours.

